12.4 PLACKETS AND FASTENERS

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- **To gain knowledge about various types of plackets and fasteners.**
- **To acquire skills in constructing plackets and fasteners.**

12.4.1 Introduction

Plackets are constructed openings that enable in giving a good fit to the garment. It helps in putting on and taking off a garment. Plackets are generally attached to waist lines, necklines, wrists and other snug fitting parts of the garment. When the garment is in use these plackets are kept closed with the help of fasteners such as zips, buttons, hooks or tapes.

12.4.2 Plackets

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A placket is made either in an opening left on the seam or by creating a cut in a garment which enables one to wear or remove the garment easily. The placket made on a seam is stronger and gives a better finish. The following points should be kept in mind while constructing a placket.

- A good placket should lay flat on the garment.
- A placket should not be thick and should not have gaps at the edges.
- The position of the placket should be easily accessible.
- The seams of the placket should be strengthened at the closed ends as it has to go through a certain amount of strain during wear.
- While choosing a placket the position of the placket, texture of the fabric, age and sex of the wearer along with the current fashion should be kept in mind.

12.4.2.1 Types of Plackets

12.4.2.1.1 Continuous Bound Placket

These plackets are made on a seam or a cut but should not be made on curved seams and bulky fabrics. This is also called as one-piece placket. They are suitable for children's dresses, undergarments like petticoats and sleeve openings where a cuff or band is used (Figure 12.24).

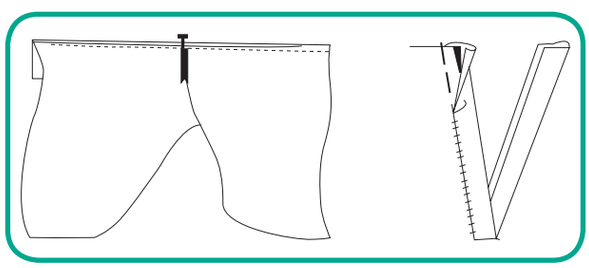


Figure 12.24 Continuous Bound Placket

Method of Sewing Continuous Bound Placket

- To make a placket in a slash, cut a strip of fabric on the lengthwise grain.
- The cut should be 3 to 6 cm wide and 3 cm longer than twice the length of the openings.
- Match the centre of a long edge of the strip to the end of the slash edge, with right sides of garment and strips facing each other.
- Pull back the tip of the slash about 0.25 cm from the edge of the placket strip and pin it.
- Open the placket edges wide and attach to the strip by a line of tacking worked 0.25 cm from the edge of the strip.

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